conditional for a Tata company signing the BEBP agreement to also adopt the TCoC and TBEM. The latter particularly obliged the signatory companies to improve their rankings in the excellence model and obtain higher scores. The BEBP agreement and the launch of the new logo, in turn, strengthened the TBEM, creating, along with other programmes, a mutually strengthening framework on which rested the new concept, idea and structure of the reinvented group. It infused ‘new spirit’ in the group, says Rajiv Dube.

Odera says that the TBEM was a ‘totally new phenomenon’ that changed the working of Tata Magadi. It helped the company measure its performance as benchmarked with the best in the world. It brought about a significant change in the best practices relating to environment, human resources and marketing.

Tata Motors in Africa also benefitted immensely from the model. It ‘sowed the seeds’ of the prospects of the company in the continent, according to Niraj Srivastav, executive director (Auto), Tata Africa Holdings. By extending its strategies, the company has made the ‘customer the centrepiece’ of its focus and partnered with them in their business, ‘plotting the operating economics’ and paying special attention to ‘uptime’ (uninterrupted availability of systems) and breakdown assistance, amongst others. In a move that made customers very happy, Tata Motors extended the warranty of some of its vehicles for five years or 500,000 kilometres. Kiran (Kiru) Shah, a fourth-generation Kenyan of Indian origin who heads Swan Carriers Ltd that operates over 230 vehicles, ascribes it to the confidence the company has in the quality of its products.

A similar view is shared by John Mulhall, MD of Tata Chemicals, North America, who was unaware that the TBEM had been initiated by Ratan as part of his restructuring process. The model was implemented in his company after the Tata Group acquired the US-based General Chemical Industrial Products (GCIP) in 2008. He says that focus of the company now is to ‘know your customer’. ‘If you know where the partner is going, partner with them in their journey’ and if ‘you are prepared to go the extra mile’, they ‘will stick with you’. With this focus, the North American division was able to secure a score of 80 to 90 per cent in the TBEM, he adds.

The Group Executive Office